

DEPARTMENT OF HUMANITIES AND SOCIAL SCIENCES
INDIAN INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY (INDIAN SCHOOL OF MINES),
DHANBAD
End Semester Examination (Monsoon Semester) 2025-26

Class: B.Tech.
Duration: 2 Hours
Date: 24.11.2025

Course: NHSA101 Communication Skills
Max. Marks: 50
Time: 1.30 p.m. – 3.30 p.m.

INSTRUCTION: All four parts of the question paper must be answered in one Answer Script. Answer the questions strictly in their respective parts.

Part I (12 Marks)

1. Read the following sentences carefully to trace out the error and rewrite them correctly. [1x6=6]

- (a) He is good with solving all computer related problems.
- (b) It takes few seconds to piece together what is going on.
- (c) Sun is declining and heat is more bearable.
- (d) I direct my inquiries to him in preference to the men who were with him at the time of the accident.
- (e) Harlow's predicament was made worsen by Broca's recently published findings.
- (f) Elliot emerged a man with a normal intellect who was unable to decide properly, especially when the decision involved personal or social matters.

2. Read the following short story and answer the questions that follow:

Jeffrey brushed quickly past an elderly woman waiting on the platform ahead of him to get onto the subway. He wanted to be sure to get a seat to read his New Economics Journal. As the train screeched out of the station, he lifted his head from the business news and stared at the man directly across from him.

A fierce wave – a tsunami – of antipathy came over him. Jeffrey knew this man, knew him all too well. They had become bitter enemies.

Their eyes locked.

As the train reached full speed, the cacophony of speeding wheels against the winding rails and of the wildly vibrating subway car filled Jeffrey's ears. To this frenetic beat, Jeffrey listed in his head all the reasons that this man, whose eyes he gravely stared into, whose image seemed to appear nearly everywhere he went, had become anathema to him.

He had climbed the upper echelons of the Wall Street firm using an imperious manner with his subordinates; issuing directives; ordaining idiosyncratic decrees; generally making certain everyone knew he was the boss.

Despite his impoverished upbringing, he had become ostentatious. Flush with cash from the lucrative deals he made on Wall Street, he had purchased a yacht and a home in Versailles. He used neither. But, oh, how he liked to say he had them. Meanwhile—Jeffrey knew—this man's father was on the verge of being evicted from his decrepit tenement apartment in the South Bronx.

What bothered Jeffrey most about this man was that he never even attempted to make amends for his evil ways.

Could this man change? Jeffrey did not know. But maybe, just maybe, he could try.

The train screeched to Jeffrey's stop at Battery Park. He gave the man one last hard look. "See you around," he mumbled to himself. And he knew he would—the wrinkled brow, that part of graying hair, those cold metallic eyes in a subway window reflection—were his own.

It would take years of hard work and self-contemplation, but Jeffrey would once again encounter this man on the train, and marvel at what a kinder person he had become.

Questions

[1x6=6]

- What is the attitude of Jeffrey in the story?
- A fierce wave – a tsunami – of antipathy came over him. Given the imagery in this sentence, which word would be the best substitute for *came*?
- Using the story as a guide, what can be inferred?
- "As the train reached full speed, the cacophony of speeding wheels against the winding rails and of the wildly vibrating train filled Jeffrey's ears." Which literary technique is used in the above sentence (from paragraph 4)?
- What is the main conflict in the story?
- What is made clear by the end of the story?
 - The man that Jeffrey dislikes is himself.
 - Jeffrey was eventually able to become a better person.
 - Jeffrey's father lives in the South Bronx.

PART II (Marks 12)

3. Do as Directed:

1X6= 6

- The movie's plot was **convoluted** and confusing, making it difficult to follow. [Write a suitable synonym of the emboldened word in the context of the given sentence]
- The essay does not need all this **redundant** background material. [Write a suitable antonym of the emboldened word in the context of the given sentence]
- The thief managed to _____ the police barricade. [Choose the suitable phrasal verb from the following list: (break through, break on, break up, break off), and fill out the blank]
- A true friend supports you _____ [Choose the suitable idiomatic expression from the following list: once in a blue moon, when pigs fly, through thick and thin, under the weather) and fill out the blank]
- The new appliances are very _____ (use) because we don't have anyone to operate them. [Rewrite the sentence using an appropriate suffix in the context of the given sentence]
- They are excavating **HISTORIC** sites in southern Arabia. [Rewrite the sentence with an appropriate prefix to the capitalized word]

4. Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions below:

Medicines have become an element of surprise and a cause of concern. This is because they have begun to aggravate diseases instead of curing them. No one has a solution. The doctors are perplexed and the patients are annoyed. The outcome of intensive research and in-depth studies has startled everyone. These findings show that unnecessary use of medicines has created a trend in which people not only take medicines for every small ailments, but also advise others to do so. This habit is now a fashion, a passion and a mark of being educated and aware. Sometimes, it is even considered a status symbol. People think that they should take strong drugs irrespective of whether the disease is minor or major. Nowadays, a shelf of medicines is found in every house. This practice is not merely confined to general medicines, but has now spread even to antibiotics. The literal meaning of the word antibiotics is – against life. In fact, due to their misuse, they have really begun acting against our life. Experts say that unnecessary consumption of antibiotics is increasing the longevity of the microbes on the one hand, while adversely affecting the patient's health on the other. This is because due to the overuse of these medicines the resistance of microorganisms is increasing, while the immunity of the individuals is decreasing. The medical experts have now begun to accept openly that neither the doctors refrain from prescribing the antibiotics for even simple ailments, nor the patients observe restraint in consuming them.

- (a) Why have medicines become an element of surprise? 1
 (b) What is the literary meaning of the word antibiotics? 1
 (c) What is the adverse effect of overuse or misuse of antibiotics? 2
 (d) Find out the synonyms of the following words from the given passage: 2
 Irritated:
 Lifespan:

Part III (13 Marks)

5. Write a persuasive paragraph on the following topic: **Can AI replace human creativity?** [Word Limit: 250 words] 7
 6. **Punctuate the following sentences:** 1x6= 6
 a. This is absolutely incredible !
 b. He asked, are you unwell.
 c. He said 'hurry up'.
 d. I love cooking meat, fish, different types of curries and baking.
 e. Martha, I barely know her resides in new delhi and is a well respected professor of ancient history
 f. His sister in law is the manager of the westin hotel.

Part IV (13 Mark)

7. Write a descriptive essay (Three to four paragraphs) on how IIT can contribute to the local community. Consider the following hints: (Social, Cultural, Educational, Economic, etc. (200 words)) 7
 8. Write a short review of your local cuisine within (three to four paragraphs) (Approx. 160 words) 6

भारतीय

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संस्थान

NGO's

↳ diff part of indi

↳ hostel, bus-station